



The beach in Lacanau, southwestern France, provided worrisome views of a nearby wildfire on Friday. France has been pummeled by a series of heat waves this year.

France, Broiling, Asks Spain for Survival Tips

By MARK LANDLER

PARIS — Jean-Pierre Farandou grew up in the sunbaked southwest of France, north of the Pyrénées mountain range, which divides France from Spain. His grandparents, he recalls, were farmers who rose to work in the cool predawn hours and rested in the heat of the day, the French equivalent of a Spanish siesta.

So, when Mr. Farandou, now France's labor minister, was

Going to Work Earlier? Perhaps. Siestas? A Tougher Sell.

searching for ways to respond to the heat waves that have recently scorched France, he instinctively cast his eye toward Spain. Mr. Farandou contacted his Spanish counterpart, Yolanda Díaz, and

proposed a field trip to Madrid, the capital, to explore how Spain has adapted to its torrid climate.

“France is discovering that in summer, it will become Spain,” Mr. Farandou, 69, said in a recent interview. “It is a country that resembles us,” he added. “We know that Spain works, even when it's hot.”

In September, when the French government's need to respond to heat waves will presumably have

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Fans of “The Odyssey” can pick a Trojan horse bucket at the theater, though it's close to selling out.

Pump Butter, Add Salt. Just Don't Toss the Tub.

By NICOLE SPERLING

First, Bill Howard surrendered his cellphone. Then he signed the nondisclosure agreement. He sat for an hour and a half that day on the Universal Pictures studio lot with a single paper copy of a script for an upcoming movie. He pored over it, alone, scribbling in the one notepad he was permitted, thinking about his craft. How would he bring his unique set of skills to bear on this particular project and

These Popcorn Buckets Have Resale Value

help to make it a blockbuster?

Many a Hollywood elite has entered a sealed room to read a top-secret script. But Mr. Howard is not an A-list actor. He's not a cinematographer or a CGI artist. What Mr. Howard makes is buckets.

Popcorn buckets — or, as they are more formally known, collectible concession vessels. These special-edition snack receptacles are designed for major movies and can sell for as much as \$70. All the studios and theater chains want in on them, because for somewhat inexplicable reasons, they have become astonishingly lucrative. AMC Theatres estimates that this year, buckets will generate \$100 million in revenue,

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200% Return For Firm Run By Trump Son

By MAUREEN FARRELL

As the Republican National Convention was wrapping up in July 2024, Republican heavyweights crowded into a rooftop bar with views of the Milwaukee skyline. In a sea of suits, Donald Trump Jr. made a beeline for a man in a black T-shirt: Shayne Coplan, the 26-year-old founder of Polymarket, the prediction market betting site.

The president's son told Mr. Coplan he was impressed with Polymarket and how its results, not the polls, reflected what he was hearing from voters about his father's prospects of returning to office. That rooftop meeting was the start of a lucrative relationship, showing how Donald Trump Jr. and his business partner Omeed Malik invested in a company whose fortunes would be affected by President Trump's policies — a scenario that has played out repeatedly as their investment firm, 1789 Capital, has grown.

In the case of Polymarket, the government had banned it from taking monetary wagers from U.S. residents, but last year a federal regulator granted it an operating license in the United States. Worth \$300 million when 1789 invested, the platform is now valued at \$15 billion.

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Measles Cases Highest Level In 2 Decades

By TEDDY ROSENBLUTH

The United States has now recorded more cases of measles in 2026 than in any other year since the virus was declared eliminated in 2000, a grim sign that the country may be headed toward a new era in which the disease regularly sickens thousands every year.

On Friday, the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention announced that there have been 2,318 confirmed cases of measles so far this year. The case count toppled the record set last year, when measles infected more than 2,200 Americans and killed two unvaccinated children. More measles cases have been reported in the United States in the last two years than in all the years from 2000 through 2024 combined.

Reversing course on measles would require a nationwide push to improve vaccination rates, a prospect that experts said seemed unlikely under the leadership of Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. He has halted funding for vaccine hesitancy research, downplayed the risks of measles and spearheaded a hunt for evidence that vaccines are unsafe.

In November, a panel of international experts will meet to determine whether the United States has lost its elimination status, which has long been viewed as

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Iran's Leader May Be More Open to Nuclear Arms

By JULIAN E. BARNES

WASHINGTON — American intelligence agencies believe that Iran's new supreme leader, Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei, is far more interested than his father and predecessor in pursuing a nuclear weapon, according to officials briefed on the assessments.

Ayatollah Khamenei's father, who was killed at the start of the war in an Israeli attack aided by U.S. intelligence, had sworn off de-

Harder Line in Tehran After Father's Killing

veloping a nuclear weapon. While American officials long asserted that Iran wanted to be capable of building a nuclear weapon, many believed Ayatollah Ali Khamenei's hesitancy was genuine.

His successor has never pub-

licly called for Iran to build a nuclear weapon. But U.S. intelligence agencies believe that Mojtaba Khamenei and the harder-line government that emerged after the United States and Israel killed many of Iran's previous leaders have ambitions to develop advanced nuclear weaponry.

The current government has already worked to assert greater control over the Strait of Hormuz and proved a difficult negotiating

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In the Shadow of Chavez

Johnny Itliong says Cesar Chavez stole credit from his father, and he has worked for decades to get the truth out. *PAGE A10*

A Second Run at FEMA?

Cameron Hamilton, who was fired after he disagreed with Mr. Trump about eliminating the agency, is back. *PAGE A9*

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Toppling Modi's Media Control

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's image is being punctured as a Gen Z-led protest movement uses videos and memes to seize the digital narrative. *PAGE A5*

Stung by Death, Then Poverty

Latin America's deep-seated inequalities prevail over Venezuela's quake victims, setting the dead apart. *PAGE A4*

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What Chatbots Think of You

Regardless of one's privacy settings, A.I. assistants learn about users from the questions that are asked. *PAGE B1*



SPORTS B6-9

Last Stop: Philadelphia

Calling it his “final decision,” LeBron James signed a veteran minimum contract to join the 76ers. *PAGE B6*

Life After the World Cup

Major League Soccer hopes to build on the event's popularity but is delaying major changes until next year. *PAGE B8*

ARTS C1-6

A Hitmaker Looks Inward

The producer Kenneth Blume, formerly known as Kenny Beats, is recognized for getting the best work out of other artists. Now, the album he's working to polish is his own. *PAGE C1*

Old Enough for ‘The Gin Game’

Debra Winger and Arliss Howard, both 71, have aged into a married-couples acting tradition and will star in a classic play, which is being staged in a bookstore where tickets cost \$20. *PAGE C1*

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Michelle Goldberg *PAGE A18*



OBITUARIES B10-11

Hip-Hop Barrier Breaker

Doreen C. Broadnax, who as the rapper Sparky D tossed verbal grenades back and forth with Roxanne Shanté in the 1980s, has died at 61. *PAGE B11*

